

Bài tập thực hành 1

What is a bad habit? The most common definition is that it is something that we do regularly, almost without thinking about it, and which has some sort of negative consequence. This consequence could affect those around us, or it could affect us personally. Those who deny having bad habits are probably lying. Bad habits are part of what makes us human.

Many early habits, like sucking our thumb, are broken when we are very young. We are either told to stop doing it by our parents, or we consciously or subconsciously observe that others do not have the same habit, and we gradually grow out of it. It is when we intentionally or unintentionally pick up new habits in our later childhood or early adulthood that it becomes a problem. Unless we can break that habit early on, it becomes a part of our life, and becomes "programmed" into our brain.

A recent study of human memory suggests that no matter how hard we try to change our habits, it is the old ways that tend to win, especially in situations where we are rushed, stressed or overworked. Habits that we thought we had got rid of can suddenly come back. During the study programme, the research showed a group of volunteers several pictures, and gave them words to associate with them (for example, see a picture of tea, and associate it with "breakfast"). They then showed the volunteers the same pictures again, and gave them new words to associate with them (see a picture of tea, and say "afternoon").

A few days later, the volunteers were given a test. The researchers showed them the pictures, and told them to respond with one of the words they had been given for each one. It came as no surprise that their answers were split between the first set of words and the second. Two weeks later, they were given the same test again. This time, most of them only gave the first set of words. They appeared to have completely forgotten the second set.

The study confirms that the responses we learn first are those that remain strongest over time. We may try to change our ways. but after a while, the response that comes to mind first is usually the first one we learned. The more that response is used, the more automatic it becomes and the harder it becomes to respond in any way.

The study therefore suggests that over time, our bad habits also become automatic, learned behaviour. This is not good news for people who picked up bad habits early in life and now want to change or break them. Even when we try to put new, good intentions into practice, those previously learned habits remain stronger in more automatic, unconscious forms of memory.

Read the following passage and answer the questions

Chú thích nghĩa:

associate with: liên quan tới

unconscious: vô thức

--	--

We can only break bad habits if people tell us to do so	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
Bad habits may return when we are under pressure	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
Researchers were surprised by the answers that the volunteers gave in the first test	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
People find it more difficult to remember things they learnt when they were young	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given
If we develop bad habits early in life, they are harder to get rid of	• A. Yes • B. No • C. Not Given

PREP.VN